Michael Shekwolo

Backend Engineer | Go (Golang) · PostgreSQL · AWS

Abuja, Nigeria (WAT, UTC+1) · Open to remote & relocation
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SUMMARY

Backend engineer specialising in **Go**, building APIs, event-driven serverless services and fintech compliance systems. Currently building payments and compliance for Zolvat EMI: QR acquiring, open banking, card issuing and a 70+ rule AML engine. Experience across fintech, energy, e-commerce and cloud infrastructure with PostgreSQL, Redis, DynamoDB and AWS Lambda/CDK. Comfortable working remotely and asynchronously, with full overlap with European working hours.

SKILLS

Languages: Go (Golang), TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, Java, Python

Backend: Gin, chi, GORM, pgx, net/http, gRPC, REST/JSON APIs, goroutines & channels, authentication & RBAC, rule engines, event-driven architecture

Data & messaging: PostgreSQL, Redis, DynamoDB (Streams), MySQL, MongoDB, Kafka, RabbitMQ, NATS

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (Lambda, DynamoDB, CDK), Google Cloud, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Git

Testing & tooling: go test, testify, Postman (automated collections), shell scripting, structured logging

Domain: Fintech: AML and sanctions screening, risk scoring, QR acquiring, open banking (PIS, request-to-pay), card issuing, FX

WORK EXPERIENCE

Full Stack Golang Developer & Assistant Team Lead (Mobile) | Jul 2025 – Present
Modular Fintech · Zolvat EMI

- Built core backend services for **Zolvat EMI** (electronic money) in Go (Gin, GORM/pgx, PostgreSQL, Redis): payments, compliance, card issuing and merchant acquiring.
- Designed the transaction-monitoring **rule engine**: **70+ AML rules** (thresholds, velocity, counterparty, geographic risk, sanctions/PEP/adverse media) with risk scoring that decides whether to **reject, flag for compliance review, or take no action**, with full audit trails.
- Built a Go sanctions-screening service (chi, Redis) that screens names and keywords against **15 sanctions lists** (EU, OFAC, FATF and others), including card-owner screening.
- Built **QR acquiring and A2A payments**: merchant onboarding API, request-to-pay confirmation, order-bound QR sessions, checkout redirect, and merchant payouts scheduled through transfer rails.
- Integrated **open banking** (Yapily, then the Revolut Open Business API with JWS-signed requests) for external transfers and request-to-pay, and built a periodic PIS subscription engine for recurring transfers.
- Built **Walletto virtual card issuing**, database-driven FX fees and P&L tracking for transfers, and a crypto-compliance prototype (Kraken, Slither smart-contract scanning, multi-chain wallet checks).
- Wrote **53 Go test files** (testify) and 110 PostgreSQL migrations across these features.

Software Engineer (Contract) & Team Lead (ZumaOS) | Cofikra Feb 2025 – Aug 2026

- Developed Go/Gin REST APIs for product catalogue, customer accounts and order processing for a computing e-commerce storefront.
- Implemented authentication, role-based authorisation, cart and order flows, and store-administration endpoints.
- Delivered the Vue 3 + TypeScript storefront and the ZumaOS product website (downloads, drivers, documentation, support).

Software Developer | Ghogl 2025

- Built serverless backend services in **Go on AWS Lambda** with DynamoDB, provisioned as infrastructure-as-code with **AWS CDK**, supporting real-time data flow for offshore and onshore energy operations.
- Designed event-driven pipelines using **DynamoDB Streams** and Lambda triggers to feed live dashboards of offshore rig sensor data.
- Automated infrastructure provisioning and hardened the event-driven pipeline, **reducing downtime by 30%**.
- Built Go Lambda APIs for equipment monitoring, maintenance scheduling, environmental compliance, safety inspections and incident reporting; optimised DynamoDB access patterns and Lambda response times.

Software Developer | Sifon 360 (UK) 2024

- Designed and built Go JSON APIs for discovering housing, religious centres, libraries and sports facilities, working with product teams on endpoint and data-flow design.
- Implemented **Redis** caching and real-time data synchronisation; added consistent error handling and logging using Go's standard library.

Software Developer | Agit Solutions NG 2022

- Built backend systems in Java (Spring Boot) and PHP for NGO case management, event coordination and beneficiary tracking; implemented authentication and authorisation with Spring Security.
- Tuned API performance for high-traffic NGO platforms; mentored junior developers and ran hands-on coding workshops.

SELECTED PROJECTS

ServAfri – Cloud platform · *Client project · Go, PostgreSQL, Next.js* michaelshekwolo.com/projects/servafri

- Go services behind a cloud console for virtual machines, networking, storage, usage metering and billing, with team access control and browser-based terminal sessions.

Aebello – Travel eSIM platform · *Go, PostgreSQL, Nuxt* michaelshekwolo.com/projects/aebello

- Go services connecting checkout and payment confirmation to eSIM provisioning, digital delivery, order status and usage tracking.

Dhylapse – Pharmacy inventory platform · *Go, PostgreSQL, React* michaelshekwolo.com/projects/dhylapse

- Multi-tenant inventory backend with batch-level stock tracking, expiry alerts, isolated pharmacy workspaces, staff access and inventory ledgers.

Redd – Real estate platform · *Client project · Go, Gin, GORM, PostgreSQL, Vue* michaelshekwolo.com/projects/redd

- Gin/GORM APIs for listings, ownership records, document access, messaging and notifications for clients and property teams.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BSc Computer Science | Lincoln University Malaysia 2024
Advanced Diploma, Software Engineering | Aptech Computer Education 2023

Certifications & courses: Build Go Apps That Scale on AWS, Basics of Go, Serverless with AWS Lambda (Frontend Masters, 2024–25) · Postman API Fundamentals Student Expert (2024)